Foundation Certificate Course on Leadership (Spark)

Date: 20th & 21st September 2025
Venue: Alverna Dhiyana Illam

Facilitators

- **Dr. Suresh Kumar Murugesan**, Psychologist
- **Mr. Ariaravelan**, Developmental Professional
- **Supporting Resource Persons:**
  - Ms. Vishnu Priya, Yellow Pond Counseling Center
  - Ms. Uma Maheshwari, Yellow Pond Counseling Center

Participants

- 21 students from **Madurai Academy**
- 4 students from **Ramnad Academy**
  Total: 25 students

Program Overview

The two-day residential Foundation Certificate Course on Leadership (Spart) was designed to nurture leadership qualities, instill clarity of vision, and equip students with practical skills for personal and collective growth. The course integrated yoga, reflective sessions, assessments, and interactive workshops to help participants understand their own leadership potential while also learning from exemplary leaders and structured frameworks.

Day 1 – 20th September 2025

Morning Yoga (6.00 am):
The day began with yoga and exercises to energize students physically and mentally.

Sessions:

1. **Brainstorming Session** – Ms. Vishnu Priya initiated the program with an engaging brainstorming activity, encouraging students to think openly and collaboratively.
2. **Leadership within and around you** – Dr. Suresh Kumar explored the foundations of self-leadership, highlighting self-awareness and influence in one's immediate environment.
3. **Leadership Styles & Exemplary Leaders** – Students reflected on various leadership styles, identifying strengths and weaknesses while drawing lessons from the lives of well-known leaders.
4. **Assessments**
   - Leadership Styles – by Ms. Vishnu Priya
   - Leadership Skills – by Ms. Uma Maheshwari
     These assessments helped students understand their natural leadership inclinations and current competencies.
5. **Creative Problem Solving & Decision Making** – Dr. Suresh Kumar taught students how to solve problems creatively and make good decisions.

Day 2 – 21st September 2025

Morning Yoga (6.00 am):
Another energizing start with yoga and exercise.

Session:

- **Review Session** – Mr. Ariaravelan started the day by revisiting the key lessons from Dr. Suresh Kumar's sessions on Day 1. This helped students recall important points and connect them with the new topics.

- **Delegation, Ethical Goal Setting, and Vision** – He explained how a good leader shares responsibilities with others, sets goals that are honest and meaningful, and builds a vision for the future. Students discussed examples of how they could apply these in their studies and daily life.

- **Creative Thinking & Brainstorming** – Through fun group activities, students learned how to think in new ways, share ideas freely, and work together to solve problems. The session encouraged them to be open-minded and innovative.

Engagement Activities: Interactive group activities were interspersed in each session to maintain energy levels and team spirit. Students actively participated, demonstrating leadership qualities such as communication, adaptability, and collaboration.

Highlights

- **Holistic Approach:** The blend of yoga, reflective learning, theory, and practice created a balanced and impactful learning environment.
- **Active Participation:** Students showed high levels of enthusiasm and commitment throughout the two days.
- **Assessments:** Leadership style and skills assessments provided students with personalized insights into their strengths and growth areas.
- **Expert Facilitation:** Both facilitators provided practical, relatable examples and motivated students to think beyond conventional patterns.
- **Collaborative Learning:** Group activities fostered teamwork, problem-solving, and idea-sharing.
-

Key Outcomes

1. **Self-Awareness:** Students identified their leadership style and areas of improvement.
2. **Practical Tools:** Participants learned structured approaches to goal setting, problem-solving, and decision-making.
3. **Vision Building:** Exposure to ethical goal setting and vision planning helped students link leadership with responsibility and integrity.
4. **Confidence & Communication:** Students gained confidence in expressing ideas, brainstorming, and working in groups.
5. **Commitment to Growth:** Feedback reflected students' eagerness to apply their learnings in academics, peer leadership, and community initiatives.

Observations

- Students were highly motivated and maintained energy levels through yoga, interactive discussions, and group activities.
- Facilitators successfully bridged theory and practice, making sessions engaging and relevant to students' contexts.
- The residential nature of the program allowed for deeper bonding, reflection, and commitment to leadership growth.
- Students expressed appreciation for the structure of the program, particularly the balance between activities and knowledge sessions.

Conclusion

The Foundation Certificate Course on Leadership (Spark) successfully created an environment of learning, reflection, and active participation. The students left with greater self-awareness, a clearer understanding of leadership principles, and the confidence to practice these in their academic and personal lives. The program has laid a strong foundation for nurturing a new generation of ethical, responsible, and visionary leaders.